MERCY'S ANATOMY

Document MA-003: Series Order & Season Structure

Canon Lock v1.2. Amends MA-001 Rule 2 and Sections 3 and 12; amends MA-002 Section 4

STATUS: LOCKED IN. *Mercy's Anatomy* is an **ongoing** series running from **2005 to the present**. **22 seasons** are ordered, for a total of **457 episodes**. Every episode corresponds one-to-one with its *Grey's Anatomy* counterpart (see §2, Equivalence Standard).

1. Official Season Order

Szn	Eps	Running total	In-story span	Hospital name	Original class level
1	9	1-9	Spring 2005	Queens Grace	Interns (PGY-1)
2	27	10-36	2005-06	Queens Grace	PGY-2
3	25	37-61	2006-07	Queens Grace	PGY-3
4	17	62-78	2007-08	Queens Grace	PGY-4
5	24	79-102	2008-09	Queens Grace	PGY-5 / Chief Resident
6	24	103-126	2009-10	Queens Grace → QG Hudson Mercy	Fellows / Attendings
7	24	127-150	2010-11	QG Hudson Mercy	Fellows / Attendings
8	24	151-174	2011-12	QG Hudson Mercy	Fellows / Attendings
9	24	175-198	2012-13	QG Hudson Mercy → Bullock Sloan Memorial	Fellows / Attendings
10	24	199-222	2013-14	Bullock Sloan Memorial	Fellows / Attendings
11	24	223-246	2014-15	Bullock Sloan Memorial	Fellows / Attendings
12	24	247-270	2015-16	Bullock Sloan Memorial	Fellows / Attendings
13	24	271-294	2016-17	Bullock Sloan Memorial	Fellows / Attendings
14	24	295-318	2017-18	Bullock Sloan Memorial	Fellows / Attendings
15	15	319-333	2018-19	Bullock Sloan Memorial	Fellows / Attendings
16	21	334-354	2019-20	Bullock Sloan Memorial	Fellows / Attendings

Szn	Eps	Running total	In-story span	Hospital name	Original class level
17	17	355-371	2020-21	Bullock Sloan Memorial	Fellows / Attendings
18	20	372-391	2021-22	Bullock Sloan Memorial	Fellows / Attendings
19	20	392-411	2022-23	Bullock Sloan Memorial	Fellows / Attendings
20	10	412-421	Spring 2024	Bullock Sloan Memorial	Fellows / Attendings
21	18	422-439	2024-25	Bullock Sloan Memorial	Fellows / Attendings
22	18	440-457	2025-26	Bullock Sloan Memorial	Fellows / Attendings
TOTAL	**457**		2005-2026		

Episode counts are the creator's, verbatim. In-story spans follow the season-to-year equivalence: each season occupies the same stretch of the real calendar as its Grey's Anatomy counterpart, with summer hiatus gaps. Exact episode dates are set when episodes are built.

2. The Equivalence Standard

Ruling: every *Mercy's Anatomy* episode is the exact equivalent of the same-numbered *Grey's Anatomy* episode (S1E1 = S1E1, through S22E18), down to the minute detail, but with **our characters**.

What matches 1:1 (equivalent)	What is ours (original)
Episode order and count per season	All character names, faces, backstories and birthdays
Story beats, twists and the order of events	All dialogue, which is written fresh in screenplay format
Which kind of character gets which arc (for example, the counterpart of each death, romance, departure or promotion)	Patient names, and the specific case wording and details
Event placement: disasters, crises, finales and cliffhangers	Queens / Long Island City setting, real 2005-2026 NYC locations
Season mythology arcs and their payoffs	The Queens Grace → Hudson Mercy → Bullock Sloan history
Act structure and where the surgery falls	News articles, social media and internet content
Relative timing (e.g. a midseason event stays midseason)	Episode titles

Writing rule: episodes are *equivalent*, not transcribed. No *Grey's Anatomy* dialogue, script text or narration is copied. Every line is written new for our characters, in our setting and in our voice. That keeps MA-001 Rule 2 (original) and this standard both true at the same time.

No-Nerf clause: where a Grey's counterpart arc would shrink a character, our version keeps the same story event, but the cause has to be earned, without reducing the character's established skill or strength (MA-001 Rule 9).

3. Calendar Notes for Continuity

- **Season 1 is short (9 episodes) and starts in spring 2005**, so the story opens in the present of 2005 as established in MA-001.
- **Season 2 (27 episodes)** is the longest season. It runs from fall 2005 to spring 2006.
- **Seasons 4 (17), 15 (15), 17 (17) and 20 (10)** are shortened seasons. Their in-story spans may be compressed, and dates must still add up.
- **Season 17 spans 2020-21.** Under MA-001 §8 (real-world context is honored), the COVID-19 pandemic is part of the in-story world for that period, as it is for its counterpart.
- **Season 20 runs in spring 2024 only**, which leaves a longer in-story gap after Season 19 to account for.
- **The July 1 residency turnover** falls in the summer gap between seasons, so class promotions (MA-002 §4) happen off-screen between finales and premieres.
- **Ages:** because the series spans 21+ in-story years, every character's age is recalculated for every dated scene. A character who is 26 in 2005 is 46-47 by 2026.

4. Amendments

Document / section	Change
MA-001 Rule 2	Expanded to cover one-to-one episode equivalence to Grey's Anatomy, with original characters and dialogue (MA-003 §2).
MA-001 §3 Season length	Was 'reserved'. Now set: 22 seasons, with counts per MA-003 §1.
MA-001 §12 Open slots	Premiere year confirmed as spring 2005. Season counts and episode orders are filled. The exact day-by-day episode dates are still reserved.
MA-002 §4	The academic-year model stands. Promotions land in the summer hiatus (MA-003 §3).

5. Canon Log Additions

ID	Established fact	Source
C-008	The series is ongoing, running 2005-present. 22 seasons are ordered.	MA-003
C-009	Episode counts per season as listed, for a total of 457.	MA-003 §1
C-010	Each episode is the one-to-one equivalent of the same-numbered Grey's Anatomy episode, with original characters and dialogue.	MA-003 §2
C-011	Each season's in-story span mirrors its counterpart's calendar window.	MA-003 §1

END OF MA-003. CANON LOCKED (v1.2).
457 episodes on the board. Next: the cast.